

Redmi 12 5G

Superb value for money

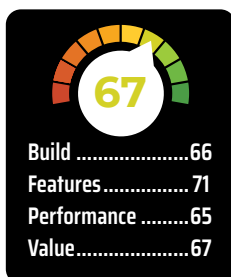
Xiaomi is back doing what it does best, democratising new technology. Given that India is a country with one of the cheapest 5G plans, there aren't a lot of people who are able to make use of the technology, mainly because of the lack of 5G-enabled smartphones in the budget segment. With the Redmi 12 5G, Xiaomi aims to make 5G more accessible for smartphone users in India.

The Redmi 12 5G was launched on August 1, 2023 at a starting price of just Rs 10,999, making it the most affordable 5G smartphone in the market. But does the Redmi 12 5G do anything more than bringing 5G to the masses? In this detailed review, we will take a look at all the smartphone's elements, to figure out what all you can get for a sub-₹12,000 budget with the latest affordable 5G offering in the country. Let's go.

DESIGN

Starting with the design, the Redmi 12 5G looks very good and premium. In this budget, Xiaomi is offering a glass back with Corning Gorilla Glass protection, which gives the smartphone a very nice and premium in-hand feel. With this smartphone, we are also seeing a new design language from the brand, which does away with the camera module. On the Redmi 12 5G, the cameras protrude straight out of the back panel and there is no separate module holding the lenses together. This gives a more seamless look to the back panel which I personally like more than having camera modules, since the thick blocks make smartphones wobble on a flat surface like a tabletop.

The Redmi 12 5G also has a metal-like frame. Now, this is still a plastic or polycarbonate frame with a metallic



“feel” to it. This is basically the paint that Xiaomi has used for the frame that gives it a nice metallic look. To the touch, however, it is easy to figure out that the “metallic feel” doesn't really mean a metallic frame on the smartphone.

While we are on the frame, Xiaomi has also curved the edges of the smartphone, which many people won't notice, but it makes holding the smartphone for a longer period of time much more comfortable. Being a Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra user, I can appreciate this since the Redmi 12 5G didn't jam into my palms every time I held on to the smartphone.

Up front, things are rather simple. We get a hole-punch implementation with a rather thick chin if we look at the smartphone from today's perspective. The smartphone has a 6.8-inch display, which is the biggest one on any Redmi smartphone so far, so the size may be a bit too big for some users, but if you are someone who plays games and watches

a lot of movies and TV shows, then this is a great bonus.

DISPLAY

Coming to the display, this is the biggest one on any Redmi smartphone so far. The Redmi 12 5G offers a 6.79-inch IPS LCD display with 90Hz refresh rate and an FHD+ resolution. On the face of it, the display looks nice and crisp with ample details for all kinds of users. Now, it may not be the sharpest and the most vibrant display, but the colour accuracy seems pretty decent for what we get in this price.

The only thing I felt wasn't up to the mark was the Redmi 12 5G's brightness. The display comes with a claimed brightness of 450 nits. We put this to test using a Lux Meter, and the results were pretty close. The Redmi 12 5G showed a maximum luminance of 407 nits on a plain white screen, with the lowest coming in at 5 nits. Now, while this is enough to allow users to use the Redmi 12 5G in all kinds of conditions, it feels kind of dull as compared to competing devices like the Samsung M13 5G. Now, this doesn't mean that the visibility is bad in bright sunlight, just that it is not the best and due to that, this panel loses a bit of vibrancy.

Coming to how responsive this is, the 90Hz refresh rate paired with 240Hz touch sampling rate makes scrolling through the screens and menus very smooth, but here also we saw a similar bug, where the refresh rate drops to 60Hz on YouTube. Now, we are not sure if this is an issue with the YouTube app or the device, but the display getting slower in specific apps is not a good experience.

Overall, I like this display. It is smooth, sharp, and very colour accurate in the “Standard” colour profile, which is this display's sRGB profile. The only thing I wasn't very pleased with is the brightness since that also impacts how vibrant the display will appear to a lot of users, but it is not a deal breaker. This is also the biggest display on any Redmi smartphone so far, so for our friends who consume most content on their smartphones, it will sit very well.